

How To Get Ahead Of 99% Of Men (Start Today) EP 330

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Executive Summary

On his 44th birthday, Brandon Carter delivers 10 brutally honest lessons learned on his path from broke in post-2008 Chicago to multi-millionaire online fitness entrepreneur — rejecting soft self-help clichés in favor of real-world, high-output strategies.

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Introduction & Context 0:50

- Episode 330 of the Victory Talk Podcast, recorded live on Brandon's 44th birthday (born September 15, 1982)
- Podcast airs every Tuesday and Thursday at 5:30 PM Eastern; this episode started at 6 PM because it's his birthday
- Brandon's framing: "I've lived a lot of life in these 44 years" — made his first million around age 31–32
 - Key promise: share 10 things he wishes he knew younger so listeners avoid his mistakes and get successful faster
- DJ Chakita Grande moderates the live comments

- Core credential: started online fitness training in 2009, one of the first online trainers ever; built it into a 7-figure then multi-7-figure business; taught over **15,000 people** how to do the same

Sponsor: Free Live Online Trainer Training 1:199

- Free live training the next day at **7:00 PM Eastern Standard Time** on how to make an extra **\$300–\$500/day** as an online trainer using AI
- What will be covered:
 - How to grow your following with AI
 - How to create content faster and better with AI
 - How to get clients — full roadmap with game plan
 - Free AI tools, including some Brandon built himself
 - Live Instagram and YouTube audits for trainers
- No certification required; no prior experience required; works part-time or full-time
- Students operate from every continent except Antarctica; example: Leonardo (Mexico), runs his whole business in Spanish, hit a **\$39K month** (new record)
- Will: full-time job, wife — made **\$5,940 in 7 days**, **\$32K+ in his first month** (joined August 8th)
- Student got first client in **10 days**
- Corey Armstrong: started with under 2,000 Instagram followers, grew to **300K Instagram + 300K YouTube**, finished last year at **\$470,000**
- Jen Caesar (nurse, two young toddlers, husband): made **\$49,927 in April**, already **\$12,577 into May** partway through the month
- Anna Quinn (22, Dallas TX): made **\$80,000 in 8 months** of online coaching after making essentially nothing before; her dad told her she'd made more in 4 months than he had
- Alejandra: made **\$9K in her first 28 days**, no prior training or content experience
- Justin: **\$10K last week**, **\$34K last month**, no prior experience, not certified
- Register via first link in description even if you can't attend live, to get on the email list

Lesson 1: Push Yourself to Maximum, Not Minimum 1:050

- Most people ask "how much can I get away with?" — the successful ask "how much can I push myself?"
- "The bare minimum crowd never runs out of reasons why things don't work for them"
- Brandon's personal story as proof:
 - At 24, his father shot himself in the head
 - Shortly after: 2008 global financial crisis — record unemployment (10%+), couldn't get a job despite having a college degree
 - Woke up at **4:00 AM** to train clients at a gym on **145th Street in Harlem**
 - Showered at the gym, took the F train to Soho to work as a security guard at **Prada** for 8 hours (standing, opening doors)
 - After that shift, worked for a **moving company**

- On weekends: trained clients in the morning, then managed a barbecue restaurant in Queens on **Steinway Street**
- Routine: **12–14 hour days, 7 days a week for approximately 2 years**
- Result: dug his family out of financial trouble, built enough reserve capital to start a business
- Key mindset: "I wasn't trying to see what's the least I can do — I went to capacity"
- Takeaway: sometimes extreme circumstances demand you go to capacity; that's how you break through

Lesson 2: Your Environment Is Stronger Than Your Willpower 1:709

- Environment is stronger than discipline AND willpower — most people underestimate this
- If your environment makes doing the right things easy and wrong things hard, you need far less discipline
- Environment sets your standards quietly and automatically — "your standards will start to drop almost automatically"
 - Analogy: a dog raised entirely around cats will start acting like a cat
- Evidence of environmental influence:
 - Your accent (not in your DNA — absorbed from surroundings)
 - Your political beliefs, religious beliefs, style of dress — all shaped by environment
 - **Academic study:** if one of your friends gets fat, you have a **40% chance** of getting fat too; if a friend of a friend (someone you don't even know) gets fat, you have a **20% chance** — measured over a long time period
- How to change your environment:
 - Step 1: Physically change your location
 - Brandon left the South Side of Chicago permanently when he went to college
 - In New York, deliberately chose **Forest Hills, Queens** (neighborhood of Donald Trump and Spider-Man's Peter Parker) — across from mansions, even while living in a small apartment
 - Would ride his bike or walk through the wealthy neighborhood to make success feel real and proximate
 - Step 2: Change the people you're around — be deliberate
 - Join organizations, groups, masterminds, mentorships with like-minded or already-successful people
 - You'll adopt their beliefs about what's possible the same way you adopted your accent
- Biblical analogy: Peter walked on water because he was around Jesus doing it — proximity to someone achieving something makes you believe it's possible for you

"I believe that a lot of you guys lack motivation because you don't really believe you can do it. If you believed 100% you could accomplish your goals, I don't think you'd have a problem with motivation."

- Lack of follow-through, consistency, motivation = product of lack of belief, not lack of discipline

Lesson 3: Performance-Enhancing Substances (The "Right Drugs") [2:361](#)

- **Disclaimer repeated multiple times:** Talk to your doctor before doing anything. This is his personal experience, not medical advice.
- Premise: first optimize the basics (sleep, diet, exercise) — these substances are for going beyond natural optimal to "super physiology"
 - "I'm talking about Steve Rogers super soldier serum level"
 - If you haven't handled the basics first, these will just bring you to regular, not exceptional
- Brandon's stack during his first million-dollar year:
 - **Caffeine:** worked up to **~1,000 mg/day** (notes Dr. Andrew Huberman takes ~800 mg on Theo Von's podcast — "rookie numbers"); now takes slightly less due to another substance giving him energy
 - Cognitive enhancement, stimulant
 - **Nicotine (patch):** wears a nicotine patch on his hip during intense work sessions — "nicotine is a potent nootropic"; prefers the patch for continuous delivery vs. Zyn/pouches; explicitly says no cigarettes
 - "Don't do cigarettes"
 - **Adderall (prescription):** took it during his first million-dollar push; 12–14 hour intense work days; very effective but highly addictive
 - Stopped once and experienced ~2 weeks of depression/fatigue during withdrawal — managed it by reminding himself it was just withdrawal
 - Now: never takes it more than **2 days in a row**; takes whole months off
 - It's an amphetamine, similar to meth/speed
 - **Modafinil (prescription):** alternates with Adderall to reduce addiction risk; anti-narcolepsy medication
 - Gives alertness without the amphetamine edge of Adderall; sometimes prefers it in the afternoon
 - Also doesn't take it every day
 - **Microdosed psilocybin:** mentions high-level entrepreneur friends (unnamed, not public) who micro-dose and report intense focus; he has tried it and says it works
 - Hardest to obtain of the three; notes you can walk into stores in Toronto for it
- Statistical context on why you need an edge: "Less than 5% of businesses ever get to a million dollars — and that's of the businesses that survive. 70–80% of businesses fail."

Lesson 4: Your Emotions Are Your Responsibility [3:073](#)

- "Saying 'this made me mad' — that's weakness. Divorce your emotions from your circumstances."
- Emotions don't have to be a conditional response to life; it takes practice
- Brandon has a **bipolar 2 diagnosis** — his doctor says he doesn't need medication because he manages it with the techniques below
- It's a spectrum — not about being 100% detached; save emotional reactions for truly big events ("if you get your arms chopped off, yeah, you're going to be sad")

- Don't give other people control over your emotions when they can't even control their own
- **Three ways to control your emotional state:**
 - **1. Physiology** — how you move and hold your body
 - Slouching and looking down actually changes neurochemistry and makes you feel worse (studies back this up)
 - "Motion creates emotion"
 - Brandon's tool: **trampoline on his balcony** — bouncing for a minute instantly changes his state; used to make his whole New York office go jump on the trampoline when vibes were off
 - "You cannot jump on a trampoline and stay in a bad mood" — also mentions jet skis
 - Build an arsenal of physical moves/postures to shift your emotional state at will
 - Assuming the stance and facial expressions of a confident person will make you feel confident within ~2 minutes
 - **2. Environment** — the people and physical surroundings around you
 - Emotions are contagious — one person in a bad mood can shift a whole room; so can a joyful person, a puppy, or a happy child
 - Deliberately puts himself in a good mood at the start of each day by taking long morning walks along the Atlantic Ocean at sunrise — "it's difficult to be in a bad mood"
 - **3. Thoughts** — the most important method
 - "Whatever you think about, you're going to feel, whether it's real or not"
 - Example: imagining your pet dying right in front of you will make you sad even though nothing happened
 - Always think about goals, what's working, where you want to go — not the bad or what could go wrong

Lesson 5: Money Won't Make You Happy — And It's Not Supposed To 3:606

- "Money's only job is to be exchanged for goods and services. It's not supposed to control your emotions for you."
- If you're trying to make money to be happy, you're confusing cause and effect — "get happy and make money"
- Money is like fertilizer:
 - Roses with fertilizer → bigger, stronger roses
 - Weeds with fertilizer → bigger weeds
 - Money amplifies what's already there; it doesn't install anything new
- One caveat: there IS a threshold income below which it's hard to be happy
 - When you can't feed your kids, can't heat your home, can't meet basic needs — that's genuinely hard
 - But **above the basic needs threshold**, more money stops being a happiness driver
- Emotions are always a range — no one hits a happiness level and stays there forever

- "I've seen homeless people sing and dance. I've seen rich people cry."
- What people probably mean by "be happy" is raising your average baseline emotional state
- "There is no unbroken boulevard of green lights. Stop thinking you're going to accomplish something and then have zero stress forever."

Lesson 6: Focus on Inputs, Not Results [3:988](#)

- Championships, physiques, and wealth are all just the visible output of years of invisible inputs
- Measure and obsess over the inputs — if you do the right inputs consistently, the outputs are mathematically inevitable
- **Fitness example:**
 - Goal: lose 10 lbs
 - Track calories burned (Apple Watch) and calories consumed (MyFitnessPal)
 - 1 lb of fat = 3,500 calories
 - Burn **1,000 more calories/day** than consumed → lose **2 lbs/week** → hit 10 lb goal in **5 weeks**
 - Don't even need to look at the scale — just verify the daily input
- **Wealth example:**
 - Age 20, goal: \$1M by age 40
 - Save and invest an extra **\$2,000/month** into the S&P 500
 - S&P 500 average annual return: **10%**
 - Result after 20 years: **\$1.3 million** — "it's just math"
- What NOT to focus on as inputs: making your bed, NoFap, cold showers
 - "I'm a multi-millionaire. I might have made my bed two or three times in the last five years."
 - "NoFap does nothing. It doesn't matter how much you touch yourself — if you burn more calories than you consume, you'll lose fat."
 - These are "male astrology" — fine if you enjoy them, but don't confuse them with goal-relevant inputs
- Sample size matters: student complained that 2 of 4 sales calls were unqualified — Brandon's response: "That sample size is not statistically relevant. If Steph Curry misses 2 of 4 three-pointers, does that mean he sucks?"
 - Keep doing the right inputs; the numbers will even out over time
- Brandon's personal example: stopped weighing himself regularly because he tracks macros and calories every day without exception — "I know what's going to happen. I'm gonna be shredded. I don't have to check."
- Chef analogy: a chef at a fine restaurant has to be on point every night because the secret food critic could be in on any night — if you do the right things every time, you don't need to check whether you're performing well

Lesson 7: Train Your Focus Through Meditation [4:572](#)

- Focus is a trainable skill, not a fixed trait — "you haven't focused because you haven't trained yourself to focus"
- Brandon meditates **twice a day, two 20-minute sessions** — one first thing in the morning, one in the early afternoon — for over **20 years**
- How to meditate (no app needed):
 - Sit quietly, close your eyes
 - Focus only on your breath
 - When your mind wanders (it will), bring attention back to your breath
 - Don't get frustrated when it wanders — getting frustrated means you didn't catch yourself; catching yourself and returning IS the rep
 - Each redirect = one rep of focus training, like a barbell curl for your brain
- Over two decades of this, his focus is dramatically improved — then he adds the performance substances on top: "next level"
- **Tim Ferriss data point:** across hundreds of podcast interviews with billionaires and elite CEOs, approximately **95% of them meditate**
- Lighthouse analogy: a lighthouse doesn't try to illuminate the whole ocean — it focuses on a narrow beam, one spot at a time, and that's what makes it effective
- "Focus is a superpower. This is a cheat code of life."

Lesson 8: Intensity Over Balance 4:784

- "Balance" advice comes from either people who already got rich or people who will never get rich
- Extreme goals require extreme action — "the world's not crazy enough for it to happen any other way"
- Brandon's first million-dollar year — what he sacrificed:
 - Missed every social function: parties, barbecues, birthdays
 - Didn't go to the movies once
 - Watched zero NFL football or NBA basketball
 - References the Thanos "What did it cost? Everything" scene from Avengers: Infinity War
- The payoff of front-loading sacrifice:
 - Now goes to Miami Heat games **courtside** (lives across the street from the arena)
 - Flies **first class** everywhere
 - Gets **paid to speak** at events instead of just attending
 - "I have a better version of all the stuff I sacrificed"
- Core choice: "Either you're going to sacrifice what you want now, or you're going to sacrifice what you want most. It's a sacrifice either way."
- Pop culture proof: no hero movie shows the protagonist living a balanced life on the way to victory — Batman, James Bond, not balanced; even Tony Stark was born a genius and born rich
- "You don't live in the Marvel Cinematic Universe. You live in the real world, where you can't stroll to your goal."

Lesson 9: Get a Mentor Who's Already Done It [5:086](#)

- A mentor compresses your timeline dramatically by eliminating trial and error
- Brandon's story with **Elliot Hulse**:
 - Met Elliot when Elliot had just hit **1 million YouTube subscribers** organically (no ads) — first fitness person to do so
 - They went out to smoke cigars in New York; during one conversation Elliot shared one strategy he'd used to make money
 - Brandon implemented it the next week: made **\$10,000 in one week**
 - Continued using the strategy: made close to **\$100,000 total** from that one conversation (~15 years ago)
 - "One conversation with Elliot Hulse made me \$10,000"
- Star Wars analogy:
 - Luke Skywalker was talented but needed Obi-Wan, then Yoda, to level up fast enough to face Darth Vader
 - "Even in a movie about green aliens and space magic, it would have been ridiculous for him to just get good without a mentor — because that doesn't happen in real life"
- Mentor-mentee relationship = "the only form of learning that doesn't fail"
 - Reading a book about swimming won't make you Michael Phelps
 - ChatGPT won't get you to the NBA
 - You need someone to evaluate you in real time and give feedback
- How to get a mentor: join a program, work for one, make friends with one — do whatever it takes
- How this applies in his High Ticket Trainer community:
 - Coaches review students' content regularly
 - Sit in on sales calls and give feedback
 - Instant coaching loop = faster improvement

Lesson 10: Engineer Your Environment for Discipline [5:772](#)

- Triggered by a super chat Q about sustaining discipline solo without like-minded peers
- Core principle: **"Discipline is for amateurs."** Structure your life so you don't need as much discipline; save discipline for emergencies
- Two-sided friction system:
 - **Things you want to STOP doing → add friction (make them harder)**
 - Remove bad food from your house entirely
 - Put your video game console at someone else's house
 - Create physical barriers between you and temptations
 - **Things you want to DO MORE → remove friction (make them easier)**
 - Alarm clock placed on the **other side of the bedroom** so you must physically get up

- Robe and Gucci slides placed right next to the alarm
- Pre-workout drink mixed the night before and waiting in the room where he works
- By the time morning meditation is done, caffeine has kicked in (~30 minutes)
- First task of the day already open on the computer before going to bed
- Studio lights permanently mounted; camera always on and ready — no setup friction
- Result: "By the time you know it, you're going" — discipline wasn't needed because the system did the work
- "Imagine if I needed discipline to set up these lights every time. That takes more discipline to set up than to just hit go."
- Also addresses the social/peer problem from the super chat:
 - Manipulate your environment deliberately when you don't have like-minded people around
 - Join communities (like his High Ticket Trainer group) where the culture supports your goals

Live Q&A Super Chats 5:626

- **Ra asks:** "I'm struggling to figure out my 10-year vision goals. Is it okay to focus on IT certifications while I figure out what I want to do?"
 - Brandon's answer: "If you are asking strangers on the internet for life advice, more education is always probably a good thing. Get more certifications, go to school — that's my go-to rule."
- **Stephen:** Sends a birthday super chat; Brandon notes he's 44 and doesn't celebrate his birthday — "I treat today like another regular Tuesday. I accept happy birthdays but I don't throw myself a party."
- **RJ asks:** How do you sustain extreme discipline building business/career/gym/sleep as a solo journey without like-minded peers?
 - Answered in Lesson 10 above — use friction engineering
- **Break Free with Chris:** Happy birthday message — Brandon thanks him
- **Manu comment:** References a previous promise Brandon made about a Go High Level affiliate link — Brandon's team addresses it live
- Closing: Episode wraps with reminder about free live training (link in description); next live episode is Thursday at 5:30 PM Eastern